Kalin Mihov

Portfolio

Self-care series|| Site-specific video performance, object (150x80x15 cm)|| Kalin Mihov, 2025

Self-care is a video performance project of landscape interventions in which the artist interacts with nature through augmented self-care tools. Back scratcher, scalp soother or body and foot massager; tools with which we take care for ourselves or our loved ones are taken and adapted to be used by the artist with the same concern for soothing the earth/soil.

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The project aims to push the boundaries of our most personal care. By entering into such intimate contact, the project wants to rethink our position in relation to the Earth. A transition from the Earth as something external to utilize, to something internal to take care of. The conceptual framework of the project is based on the work of Bruno Latour - After Lockdown: A Metamorphosis (2021). In it, Latour offers a new reading of Kafka's Metamorphosis, finding a parallel between the man who wakes up in lockdown with a greater understanding of the planetary consequence of his action and Kafka's character, who wakes up one morning to find himself transformed into a giant insect-like creature.

To date, one work from the series has been realised. *Do You Really Self-Care?* was presented in a solo exhibition at Posta Gallery, Sofia, Bulgaria in 2025, within a project realised with the financial support of the Ministry of Culture. A 24-second excerpt from the video artwork is available on the artist's website.



Do you really self-care?, video still, 2025





Do you really self-care?, video still, 2025

Treadmill series || video art, performative object || Kalin Mihov, 2024

The Treadmill series is an ongoing series of video actions in which Mihov uses a treadmill-like object to engage with the surrounding environment. The performances stage surreal and absurd encounters with the landscape, reflecting on the Sisyphean struggle inherent in humanity's relationship with nature — one marked not by acceptance, symbiosis, or balance, but by continuous extraction, control, and conflict. Movement without progression becomes a metaphor for the ecological condition of the Anthropocene, where attempts to master nature ultimately reinforce cycles of depletion and exhaustion. The series invites reflection on the contradictions of human activity within this context.

To date, two works from the series have been realised: *At the beginning of every river stands a treadmill* and *How many treadmills does it take to make a Landslide.*

At the beginning of every river stands a treadmill was created during the International Gabrovtsi ART-NATURE Symposium and is featuring the Treadmill object made from natural materials - tree trunks and branches with a working mechanism for running. The performance marks the tenth anniversary of a flood, which completely changed the river of Enyovitsa, where the performance was made. In recent years, the region has often experienced droughts, and problems with water infrastructure, leaving local residents without water. In the action, the artist attempts to "activate" the river through the treadmill mechanism.



At the beginning of every river there is a treadmill, video still, 2024





At the beginning of every river there is a treadmill, detail and exhibition view, 2024

Treadmill series || video art, performative object || Kalin Mihov, 2024

How many treadmills does it take to make a landslide was created and presented at the Medienfrische artist residency and festival in summer 2024. It features a lightweight treadmill-shaped structure without a mechanism, with the artist running on a landslide and using the motion of falling rocks.

The work was later presented at Sofia Art Fair 2024 together with *At the beginning of every river stands a treadmill* . A 30-second excerpt from the video series is available on the artist's website.



How many treadmills does it take to make a landslide, still images from video performance, 2024





How many treadmills does it take to make a landslide, still images from video performance, 2024

Immortelle promises || site-specific video performance|| Kalin Mihov, 2024

Immortelle promises is a video work in which the artist undertakes a surreal and ultimately futile attempt to collect the flowers of the immortelle plant and construct a protective armour from them. Set within a rocky coastal landscape on the island of Hvar, Dalmatia, the action stages a fragile negotiation between body, plant, and terrain, where protection becomes both impossible and absurd.
The video work is the basis for a later developed object series named Armor Series.

Immortelle promises was realized during the Jelsa Art Residency (2024), part of the program of the Jelsa Art Biennial.



Immortelle promises, still image from video performance, 2024





Immortelle promises, still image and detail, 2024

I am the wild strawberry meadow || Body art; photography || Kalin Mihov, 2023

“I am the accessible monument
(it's pleasant to say "I" once in a hundred years)
M. Bodakov, 2018

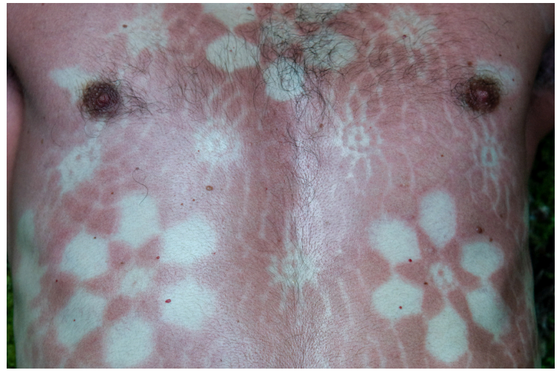
I am the wild strawberry meadow examines man's relationship with the passing of time through melancholy, surrendering to time and accepting its scars, reconciliation and the inevitable reckoning.
For four hours, the artist subjects himself to direct sunburn, printing knitted lace with a pattern of strawberry leaves on his body. The project deals with the human-time-heritage relationship. The photographs show the beginning and the end of the work process and demonstrate (at least) two imprints – of the accumulated values of generations on the person and of physical time on the person.

The knitted lace is an object associated with the leisure labor of mothers and grandmothers, serving as a celebration of the mark they have left behind. In reality, everyone carries this imprint. In this act, the artist chooses to make their mark visible.

The artwork was presented as part of the group exhibition *Made in Leshten* at Little Bird Place, Sofia, Bulgaria (2023).



I am the wild strawberry meadow I, 2023





I am the wild strawberry meadow, working process and detail, *2023*

Hiding from the Highway|| performance|| Kalin Mihov, 2023

Using his own body as material, Kalin Mihov lowers himself to the edge of the mountain, building a niche in which to rest, meditate and live as a hermit. All this in front of the panorama of the motorway, a post-industrial giant horror that presents itself as a sort of stain in the panorama of the San Jachiddu Ecological Park.
In a world where natural places are increasingly rare and forced to coexist with advancing civilization, the artist decided to show the process by which a hermit is created, building a real hideout from the modern world.
Working the land sometimes means engaging in a battle with it. But it is only through this war that man can find peace, adapting nature to himself and allowing it to grow in the best possible way. For men, this war translated into a desire for domination that ended up destroying nature in an attempt to domesticate and dominate it. The hermit, on the other hand, is first and foremost the one who understands the need for pacification, who inhabits a place to take care of it, elevate it and let it express all its potential.
For this reason the performance is accompanied by a sculpture representing a chrysalis. A natural symbol of transformation, it is placed by analogy next to the working man, to indicate two homologous processes that occur in opposite ways: one through rest and unconsciousness, the other through activity and fatigue. It thus represents the hermit's objective: because in nature everything is transformation, there is nothing but becoming.
Text: Leonardo Sforza
Hiding from the highway was created during International Nature Art Residency Synesthesia in Messina, Italy.



Hiding from the highway, documentation of performence, 2024





Hiding from the highway, documentation of performence, 2024

Riverman|| video performance|| Kalin Mihov, 2023

Riverman – an act in which Kalin Mihov dedicatedly repeats the simple act of persistently rubbing a dense stone into another larger, softer sandstone every day in the span of a week, until it leaves a significant mark on the surface and body of the second, just as running water would do over it in the course of decades. The project evokes a multilayered set of interpretations, both inwards and outwards looking – it represents the humanistic idea that man can challenge the elements (water, earth, wind, fire), that there is no difference between them and that man is an element himself – something Mihov sincerely believes. Or it can also be seen as a metaphor and an opposition to the hectic, fully optimized, and mentally exhausting world of today, questioning what is the significance of one's efforts in everyday activities.

Riverman was shown in the 1m² Art exhibition project, TaM Veliko Tarnovo, Veliko Tarnovo, Bulgaria (2023), curated by Martina Yordanova. A 24-second excerpt from the video artwork is available on the artist's website.



Riverman, final object, 2023





Riverman, working process

Pillow work: Day 4 Pillow Fight|| happening || Collaboration Marieke Leene & Kalin Mihov, 2024

Marike Leene and Kalin Mihov organized a five-day event to mark the end of their joint residency at Jelsa Art Hub. The event included a series of happenings, performative acts and temporary installations that engaged the local community.
During the week, they collaborated with middle school students to create an ephemeral land art installation in the city park, they cleaned sections of the city's infrastructure in a day-long performance and they spend one day in carrying load of pillows around key locations of the city to explore in detail the notion of *pillow work.
On the fourth day, they marked an arena in the city's central square, inviting locals and guests to take part in a therapeutic pillow fight. Open to participants of all ages, the activity served as a playful means of releasing energy and stress. An unexpected ending to the event was a pillow fight between all the cafe owners in the square

pillow work is a feeling which manifests itself when the worker is faced with hard work, which, however, remains unreachable to him. It lies between the worker on one side who perceives this work as not hard enough and is dissatisfied with the impossibility of associating himself with genuinely hard work, however he does not regret taking it easy and would not raise the issue. On the other side, the contractor, for various reasons, also does not assign the worker the aforementioned hard work. These reasons could be because the worker (and the coiner of this definition) is perceived as a guest, a tourist or a sensitive person and might actually not be capable of the job mentioned.



video still from the documentation of the event





video still from the documentation of the event

Dump yard Inventory||site-specific installation||sorted waste, lime, 192 sq. m||Kalin Mihov, 2022

Kalin Mihov's installation *Dump yard Inventory* systematizes pictorial compositions of various materials, textures and colors, created on the site of an unregulated landfill near the village of Gorno Pestene located in Northwest region of Bulgaria - the poorest region in Europe. The individual components and the interrelationships accumulated over time between them are carefully classified into a new, non-place-specific structural unity, essentially nothing is added and nothing is taken away from the place, only the nature and function of the objects is changed.

In the form of a happening, with the support of residents of the village , the landfill is sorted into a table with an area of 192 square meters, in which each cell contains a different type of found waste. Focusing in this way on the chronic problems for peripheral areas in Bulgaria - the lack of good infrastructure and logistics for regular garbage collection, limited or absent access to the possibility of separate collection of waste and its recycling -, *Dump yard Inventory* also refers to more central questions for the contemporary man: over-consumption, the human footprint on nature, waste management and climate change.



Dump yard Inventory, aerial view, 2022





Dump yard Inventory, detail, 2022

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